

Offering Your Soul to His Word

Kenneth Hagin's Tapes Taught Me to Hear the Message Beneath the Manner

Let me give you some exhortation.

I was an ultra, ultra, ultra-holiness Pentecostal boy when somebody handed me an old reel-to-reel tape by Kenneth Hagin. In those days, he would teach two to two and a half hours, and you had to put the reel-to-reel tape on low speed to capture the whole message.

Even though his strongest mantle was the prophet's, he would rather teach than operate under the prophet's mantle. In fact, several times he got into trouble because he just wanted to teach and God wanted to move. Most of the times he got sick were when he violated that standard. Finally, in the hospital, Jesus would come in and say, "I would like to talk to you. Would you like to be a prophet next month?"

He would say, "Yes."

So somebody gave me those tapes. The first time I listened to him, he sounded like a man standing in a washtub, talking monotone.

"Well, sir, when I was a young Baptist boy on the bed of affliction, God healed my body."

He would go into great detail, even which direction the bedroom faced, west or east, and the exact time.

Well, you would remember that if you were going to die of four different diseases and then got healed. Amen?

I listened to him for a while and thought, This guy does not have anything.

You have to understand, there were no teachers in the holiness move. There just were not. The pastors were all evangelistic preaching machines. To us, teachers were people stuck in the back room with the children. We were used to preaching like this:

"I want you to know that God is going to send you to hell with brimstone fire! You will scream if you do not quit eating with plastic forks!"

I had you, did I not?

Now, thank God, the anointing is on the service. That is where I got it from. That was me. If you will excuse me, we would scare hell out of people.

Then I heard Kenneth Hagin:

"Well, when I was a young Baptist boy on the bed of affliction..."

Oh, man.

Confession Became Real When Poverty Pressed Me Into the Prayer Closet

God moved on me with a vision, and I went full time. I was locked up praying, running out of food, money, and everything else. Then I remembered a tape called *How to Write Your Own Ticket with God*.

I had taken some of my last money and bought an old Wilcox tape recorder. It had a plaid cover that looked like polyester. That old box was about to break down, but it would play Hagin's tapes.

I would put the tape on, and it would go:

"When I was a young Baptist--croak--boy on the bed of--croak--affliction--croak."

That machine was about to die any time.

I got his tapes out because I thought, Now wait a minute. Maybe I should hear what he says instead of how he says it.

So I listened to *How to Write Your Own Ticket with God*. Of course, he taught about confession. Then I listened to his testimony, and I understood confession. I began to pick up on it.

I started confessing that I had money, even though I was about three months behind on everything. I would pray in tongues, then stop and use my confession for a while.

I remember that at times something would pass through me, and I did not know what it was. Even though I could not pay my bills, and I did not know whether the grocery store was going to cut off my account so I could not get food for the children, something would pass through me. I called it mixed emotions.

When it happened, I would feel incredibly rich, as though everything was going to be all right. Then I would go back out into the world to do the things you normally do, and I would think, What is wrong with you? How can you feel so good when you are about to starve to death?

Then I would go back into my closet and do it again.

I did not know that what was passing through me was the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ:

"Though He was rich, yet for your sakes He became poor, that you through His poverty might be rich."

I did not know I was experiencing little bits of that standing, that grace He gave. He took my poverty, incurred my debt, and gave me His standing. I did not know that was what I was touching.

I remember coming home so excited. I would string that Wilcox tape recorder up and put the speaker between the pillows on the bed, because the speaker stretched out on a wire. I would turn it way down:

"When I was a young Baptist boy--croak--on the bed of affliction--croak."

Finally, Rosalie said, "Who are you married to, that speaker or me?"

I would go to sleep listening to him. The tape would take three hours, and when it ran off the reel, the machine would shut off. So I listened and listened.

A Seven-Hundred-Thirty-Six-Dollar Check Became a New Day of Faith

We were down to nothing. We needed \$500 to cover three months' worth of debts. An incredible \$500. I was sick because I owed so much money.

I remember finding the books for the first year of this ministry. The whole year equaled about three days now.

Then I got a call from an evangelist I was helping. He was a holiness-charismatic kind of man, and I had been helping him as catcher, car driver, gas filler, and things like that. He asked, "Would you like to go do a meeting with me in Salem?"

I thought, I would like to, but I cannot get there. I do not have gas. I do not have anything.

Then a woman asked, "Would you like to go?"

I said, "Yes."

She said, "Well, let's take my car and go."

Glory to God. Let's take your car.

So we went to the meeting. I caught people as normal. Then I started getting a headache. In those days, before my major fast, I got headaches. I do not get them anymore. I used to take handfuls of those blinding little white things to get rid of them. Not anymore. I do not have pain anywhere now.

I was catching people, and pretty soon my head was going boom, boom, boom. Then a man came up to me and said, "God told me to do something. He told me to do something."

I thought, What?

He handed me a piece of paper. I hardly knew what a Pentecostal handshake was, much less a note. So I opened it right in front of him and looked at it. It was a check. You are not supposed to do that. You are supposed to run into the bathroom and look at it there.

My head was pounding so badly that I could not read the figure. The numbers jumped. I thought it said \$7.36.

That was appreciative. That was a lot of money.

I started to put it in my pocket, then thought, I will look at it one more time.

My eyes focused. It said \$736.

Oh my God. I started shaking. I put it in my pocket. I did not want to tell the evangelist I was helping. Later he found out and thought it should have been given to him.

I was shaking. My head was pounding, and exceeding joy welled up in me. "Oh, glory to God. Oh, glory."

I stuck it in my pocket. Every couple of minutes, I would lift my hand and pat my pocket to make sure it was still there. I would rub it and feel it.

On the way home, I decided to tell Rosalie quietly. I said, "Rosalie, somebody gave me a check for \$736."

She said, "Oh my God!"

When I got home, even though I had that check, I wanted to go to bed because my head was pounding. But not her. She wanted to talk about it.

"We got \$736!"

I said, "I know it. I know it."

And by the way, she said, "You can listen to that tape recorder all night if you want to."

People, the next day was the dawning of a new day. I had stood so long against emotions and circumstances that when I received that money, it was like the dawning of a new day. I had received something incredible with my faith, an incredible faith in God. From that day to this, my faith in His faithfulness has not been shaken.

I did not have gas for the car, but the bank was within walking distance, over a bridge and over a railroad track. I remember it was a sunny day. I was walking to the bank. The birds were singing. The butterflies were flying. The dew on the flowers sent little messages to me, little rays of light shooting through the tiny prisms of water. The sky was incredibly bright. I felt like two million dollars.

I deposited the check and asked, "When you get this in my account, can I write checks on it?"

They said, "Yes, you can."

I said, "I mean today."

They said, "Yes, you can."

I went down and paid the grocery store, caught up on our rent, paid our telephone bill, and had \$100 left over to sow into somebody's ministry.

There is never a day like that. Never.

Baptizing the Soul in His Presence Defends You Against Accusation

Many times when the devil assaults and attacks, he loves to indict God for unfaithfulness by using circumstances. One of the greatest defenses against an emotional atmosphere that says day and night, "You are going to fail," is to baptize your soul in His presence.

The circumstances and emotions of where your life is will try to defeat you. That is when one of the most important things you can do is baptize your soul in His presence.

How do I do that?

When I want edification, I pray in tongues. There are not necessarily feelings with edification. Sometimes I spend days without any particular feelings. Edification is a process. Praying in tongues causes a process by which you are transformed to the Word that you know.

Worship brings presence. I could be in the middle of hell and start worshiping God, and Jesus would walk right in there with me because worship brings presence. The battleground is generally in the soul. When you add the presence of God to the battle, it will not be long before Jesus comes back on one of His return trips with a big fat answer of some kind in His hand.

You may say, "Well, I have been unfaithful in the past with my giving and tithes."

Thank God that giving and tithing are instructions of grace, and His mercies are new every morning. His mercy is as new as your repentance, as new as your dedication, as new as your lifted hands when you say:

"It is over. I choose Your presence over anything the devil has said. Today is new, and I am going to walk new."

The devil will say, "But your past--"

Shut up about my past. I have an Advocate, Jesus Christ the righteous. He is faithful and just. If I repent and walk my repentance out, He will cleanse me from all unrighteousness of my past, from anything you have to say. It has been cut off by the blood of Jesus.

The Word Must Be Planted Before Its Image Can Come Forth

Jesus said, "If you had faith as a grain of mustard seed..."

Think about that. A mustard seed has the diagramming and programming for what will be. Inside that seed is the image and program for an entire tree and the harvest of fruit on that tree. It is all lying dormant in that little seed.

They have found wheat in Egyptian tombs. Because it is so dry there, that wheat was thousands of years old. They planted it, and it grew.

Your faith is waiting on you. How long are you going to leave it dormant? How long are you going to leave it in the seed?

Someone says, "I just love His Word. I have my Bible. I just love it."

People, Jesus said, "My words are spirit, and they are life." As long as you leave that Word on the mantle of your fireplace and do not plant it in the ground, the image inside it will not come out.

The seed is made out of the same kind of substance as the ground. When you plant it in the ground, which is the human heart, and then pray in the Holy Ghost, worship, and confess His Word to water it, the life that was lying dormant in that seed will spring to life. Whatever is in the image of the seed is what will come out.

But if you leave the Word on the mantle and say, "It is the Word of God. I have the highest respect for it. I worship it. Hail to the Word! I have a Bible!" then the image in it will not come forth.

Jesus said, "My words are spirit, and they are life." When you plant that Word in the ground, the human heart, and believe on Him as the Scripture says, out of your belly, your spirit man, your inner man, will flow rivers of living water.

Praying in tongues is one way to throw water on the Word after you plant it in your ground. When you start praying, the seed is watered. It will germinate. Whatever is in that seed will begin to come out.

What You Plant Is What Will Come Up

Someone says, "Brother Roberson, you can pray and ask God to pay your bills, but you never know what God is going to do. Maybe leaving you in debt a little longer is really good for the development of your character."

Tell my bills that. Tell the people I owe. Tell my creditors. Do not tell me that it is making God happy. Please go talk to them. They do not understand what you said.

People say, "You just never know what God is going to do. You can pray and ask Him, but you do not know what He will do because you do not know what is good for you."

I know. I know. You never know what He is going to do. Just as sure as you plant corn, wheat will come up.

"I planted some corn the other day, and wheat came up."

No. Whatever you plant is what is going to come up. If you plant a big fat seed in you that says you are out of debt, and you water it sufficiently, that seed is going to come up. You will find yourself out of debt, and sinners will want to be like you.

The Holy Spirit Lives to Teach the New Creation the Truth

Your teacher, the Holy Spirit, is the teacher of your spirit. He is the instructor of your new creation, your new nature. He is the wisdom to your understanding. He has come to bring forward everything you are as a new creation.

Because He is your teacher, His primary commission is to guide you into all truth.

In John 17, Jesus said, "Thy word is truth." The thing the Holy Spirit strives to do the most is guide you into all the truth of His Word. That is what He strives for.

I know we enjoy the presence of the Holy Spirit. In any worship service, when He glorifies Jesus, that is when you feel the presence magnified. People say, "I feel the presence of the Holy Spirit here." But whom He is glorifying is Jesus. You really cannot feel Him glorifying Himself, because He was not sent to glorify Himself. When you begin to feel those things, you can know Jesus is in the service. He comes, and when He comes, He is the Word.

Then things begin to get...

For he that has an ear to hear, let him hear what the Spirit would say to the church. For there are many things I desire you to walk in, but no one walks in these things until maturity takes place.

I have many things to teach you, but as of yet, not many are able to bear them. I have areas for you to walk in that the world could only testify, "God had His way."

Hear what the Spirit would say. Great things are waiting for you as you continue your journey into My Word and into My heart, says the Spirit of the Lord.

The Holy Spirit is primarily your teacher. I love the goose bumps I feel when He comes into the service. So do I. I love God's presence. But His first and foremost commission to you is to guide you into truth, establish you in the Word, inoculate you against deception, and seal your fate that heaven will be your final home.

He goes even further than that. He seals the fact that you will receive everything you need to fulfill your ministry. He is the earnest of your inheritance, ensuring that you will end up with a glorified body. That is His ministry.

There is only one guarantee He can give you that you will end up there: you must let the ministry of the Teacher on the inside of you loose.

You have to turn Him loose.

There are ten thousand different opinions from pulpits every Sunday, even in this million-person area. They cannot all be right when they differ on every issue. Yet we have only one Teacher, sent to guide us into all truth.

Where did the system break down? Was the system God gave us no good? Does it carry no guarantees? How can I be a tongue-talker and be deceived?

The system is good. The breakdown is not on God's part. The breakdown is on people's part.

In His first and foremost commission, the Holy Spirit lives for the day when your character and walk with God become such that you are totally willing and submitted to be led, guided, and surrendered into all truth. He lives for the day when He can inoculate you against deception and begin His ministry as the Teacher of your new nature and the wisdom of your understanding.

The Teacher Needs the Raw Material of a Soul Offered to the Word

The Holy Spirit also lives for the day when you discover this: He lives for the day when you will help Him by offering your soul for transformation on the altar of God's Word.

Your great Teacher on the inside of you lives for the day when you offer your soul in the meditation of His Word. He lives for the day when you feed into your spirit, through meditation, all the raw material the Holy Ghost needs to make a transformed, devil-stomping, mountain-moving, ministry-fulfilling, entrepreneur, apostle, prophet, teacher, multitudes-of-people-saving vessel.

He lives for that day.

To say, "I will be led," is to take that mustard seed that lies dormant, like that ancient wheat from the pyramids, and plant it.

Someone says, "My grandpa believed this way, and his grandpa before him believed this way. My mama believed this, and their people believed this, so that is the way I am going to do it."

Really? You mean that seed has been dormant that long?

You may have a dormant seed, but it is mustard-seed faith. If you have the seed, you have enough faith to get what is inside it out.

Mustard-seed faith is faith to do what you are supposed to do in the heat of the battle. When 1,800 devils traveling with a ruler of darkness move in on you for praying too much and say, "When I get done with you, you will get slapped so hard you will never think about prayer again," mustard-seed faith is enough to walk out there, lift your hands, and start worshiping God because He is not a liar and because He is victorious.

You do not say, "God, I thank You for not being a liar," as though you are accusing Him. You say, "I thank You that You are not a man that You should lie. I thank You that You have exalted Your Word above Your name."

You have enough faith in the mustard seed to do the right thing. You have enough.

"I do not feel like it."

You do.

"But you do not understand how I feel, Brother Roberson."

I know it. My God, I know it. Your temptation is not uncommon to man. The devil has not been allowed to give you the first temptation since Adam that nobody else has faced. Jesus may have been the firstborn from the dead, born out of death, but you are not the first person to receive a temptation uncommon to man. God is faithful. He will make a way of escape, and you will be able to bear it.

The devil will tell you, "Nothing works for you. You are different."

That is a lie.

You say, "You do not understand what I am going through."

Yes, I do. I think I have at least a glimmer of a hint. I have seen ten to fifteen hundred people saved and filled with the Holy Ghost in a five- or six-week period, and the devil moved in and attacked me viciously.

But you are right. The devil does not stomp on people for getting souls saved and listening to people's problems for eight hours a day during prayer. He does not stomp on a man whose main source of food is other people's problems. Oh no, it is just you.

But do not worry about your problems. They do not get on me or in me. Hallelujah.

I understand what you are going through. And I am telling you: you can. You think you cannot, but you can. You can go lift your hands and invite God in to baptize your soul with His presence. Invite Him into your emotions. Begin to worship until your ground is stable. Then speak His Word.

I am telling you that you can.

The Rebirth Explains Why the Holy Spirit Has Something to Teach

The Holy Spirit lives in great hope for the day when you will offer your soul on the altar of God's Word.

Our preachers' conference is coming up in about a month. This is a special preachers' conference. We are not having night services. They are all day services. This is where we are actually going to get into the things we know these preachers have come to the place to do.

This is not the general open conference where nine countries and fifteen states came in and everybody who wanted to come came. It is not exactly that kind.

Somebody asked me, "What are you going to preach during the preachers' conference?"

I said, "The rebirth."

She said, "Oh, brother, I really set myself up for that one, did I not?"

The rebirth. Sure. I looked at her as though to say, What did I say?

Then I thought for a minute, That does sound awfully funny: a big preachers' conference, and I am teaching on the rebirth, on being born again and what it means.

But the fact is, I was quite serious. After she got done laughing, I thought, There is no use trying to explain.

The truth is, I am going to teach on the rebirth. If you do not understand who you became when you were born again, then you will not understand the ministry of the Holy Spirit. Everything you are in the rebirth is what the Holy Spirit brings forward.

You now have a nature, because you have been born again, that can understand the mind of Christ. You have a nature that can understand who and what God is. Before that, the Holy Ghost had nothing to teach.

That is why when Paul referred to the law, he said that which was meant to be life to him became death. When he talked about Moses' veil, he called it the ministry of condemnation. Why? Because spiritually dead men cannot stop lying, cheating, committing adultery, and coveting.

When the commandment came and said, "Stop," a spiritually dead man could not.

That is why Paul said, "I had not known covetousness, except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet."

A spiritually dead man is a spiritually dead man. You can take a mule, crop his ears, braid his tail, paint him, call him a racehorse, and put him in with Thoroughbreds, quarter horses, and Arabian stallions. They can open the gate, and even though everyone thinks it is a racehorse, a mule is coming out of that gate.

The mule did not know he was a mule until they put him up against the racehorses.

Paul said, "I had not known sin." How would I know? It was my nature.

You are what you are. If you have the nature of sin, that is what you are. That is why you cannot quit without a nature change.

So Paul said, "O wretched man that I am! Who shall deliver me from the body of this death?"

Then he answered his own question: "I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord."

In the next chapter, he changed his covetousness. "There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus." To the born-again man and woman, no condemning sentence from the flesh, the devil, or the world can be carried out in me anymore because I have been born

again. The law of the Spirit of life has kicked in, and I am walking according to that law instead of the law of sin and death.

Now who is going to teach my new nature?

He sent your Teacher. His first and foremost commission is to guide you into all truth. He takes everything God has made you in your new creation and brings it forward. When He brings it forward, the soul falls to defeat and begins to line up with everything God is doing.

That is called the walk of the Spirit and transformation. It is not will worship. It is mortification.

The Canon of Scripture Is the Altar Where the Soul Must Be Offered

Little ones, the Holy Spirit lives in great hope that you will offer your soul on the altar of God's Word, on the canon of Scripture left by the apostles who were charged with walking with Jesus and then handed their mandate down and trained others.

Paul said, "As a wise master builder, I have laid the foundation." There is no other foundation than the one that has been laid, so take heed how you build on it.

Those men gave their lives and established the canon of Scripture so that you and I can go to the Word of God, embracing the Teacher on the inside of us, and offer our soul to the revelation they died to put on paper.

Show some respect, for God's sake, and go do it.

Am I making myself clear?

John's Long Walk of Love Shows What the New Nature Produces

I cannot stop talking about John. There is no fitting way to wind this down.

There was something in John even before he was born again. The apostles were not born again until after the resurrection of Jesus. The rebirth was not available yet. The firstborn had not been born from the dead. How could Jesus be the firstborn if anyone had preceded Him in the rebirth?

Romans 8:29 says that those He foreknew, before the cross, He predestinated to be conformed to His image. They had to wait for the cross. The image they were to conform to, so that He might be the firstborn among many brethren, had not come into existence yet.

Someone says, "I thought He predestinated who would be saved and who would not."

He is not willing that any should perish. The predestination was to the cross, because the image had not yet come into existence. Everyone in Abraham's bosom who embraced the promise had to wait for the resurrection.

John was not born again yet. Peter was not. That is why Jesus told Peter, "Satan has desired to sift you as wheat, but I have prayed for you, that your faith fail not." The period He was talking about was the crucifixion, the three days, the resurrection, and the Holy Spirit's coming back. Then He said, "When you are converted, strengthen your brethren."

Where did the conversion come from? Did Jesus not breathe on them and say, "Receive ye the Holy Ghost"?

The Holy Spirit came in a measure. Jesus was the first one to receive Him without measure. Scripture says He spoke the words of God.

Jesus was born spiritually alive because His Father was God. He was immaculately conceived of the Holy Spirit, the first man in four thousand years to be born out from underneath the curse. For the first time, a man's spirit was capable of receiving the baptism of the Holy Spirit. Jesus received Him without measure.

In the Old Testament, the measure in which men received the Holy Spirit was only the measure of the soul. Their spirits had a nature that could not receive the baptism, so the Holy Spirit would come and baptize their souls for a purpose, a pursuit, or a plan of God, and then withdraw Himself.

Jesus breathed on the disciples and left the Holy Spirit with them until He came and finished redemption. Then the Holy Spirit, in His everywhere presence, could finally baptize them, move into their spirits, and abide with them forever.

He needed to, because you needed a Teacher for your new nature and an Instructor for the wisdom you have received.

I am now borne witness to by the Holy Spirit because I have the same nature God has. The witness in me is the same witness that is in the Holy Spirit. I have God's nature. He can now witness to me that I am a son of God.

That great Teacher lives for the day when you will give your soul to the altar of God's Word.

Those great men who went before you laid their lives down to leave you a legacy, not a dormant seed on the mantle of a fireplace. They left a living Word, worthy of more than skimming and more than an occasional out-of-context reading.

What was it in John, even unregenerated? What was it in his character, of all the men in the world, that caused Jesus to look at him and say, "John, adopt My mother"?

Mary had other sons in the flesh. "Honor your father and your mother." You are not going to cuss your mother, even if you are high on dope, and get away with it. Nobody does.

What was it in this man? He lived some twenty-five to thirty years longer than any other apostle who walked with Jesus. Why? For one reason: he took care of the mother of Jesus in her old age until she died peacefully in his house in Ephesus.

Then, some years later, he was banished to the Isle of Patmos, a penal colony off Turkey, where he broke rocks in the mines at one hundred years old. He outlived the emperor Domitian, who was impeached and put to death. Then John was brought back and oversaw the churches in Asia Minor for several more years.

What was in this man?

His crowning achievements were the testimony of Jesus and receiving and recording the book of Revelation from the Isle of Patmos. John was a testimonial. The book of Revelation was the recording of a revelation.

John's own contribution to the church, achieved through praying, wisdom, and walking with God, was the testimony of Jesus in his letters. First, Second, and Third John together are five simple chapters and two paragraphs. Approximately eighty-five years of walking in love, ministry, and power recorded the wisdom captured in those five small chapters.

Show some respect. Show some respect.

The heart of that whole book is this: if you have been born of Him, then that new nature is going to take you into a fervent, agape love for the brethren. If that is not the path you are on, then you are not walking into God.

Here is the crowning achievement of the man who took care of Mary. The Holy Spirit wants to transform you to agape. Hallelujah.

Meditation Begins by Letting a Whole Book Form Its Outline in You

Would you like a real quick lesson on meditation? I will give you one.

The instruction was to meditate the Word day and night. How can you do that? How can you carry on the natural aspects of your life and meditate day and night?

I love prayer day. I love people. You do not pray all your life until God begins to use you to set people free and then say, "I cannot set you free; I need to pray." That is called religion.

Yes, I will help people. Many times I am caught up in counseling on the day of prayer, even though there is nothing I love more than to stroll around and pray in the Holy Ghost and encourage you to pray, because I know what is going to happen to you.

So how do I meditate day and night?

I can tell you a beginning. You need to take a small book like the book of John. If you follow me closely, I can teach you to assimilate. There is a big difference between meditation day and night for the assimilation of His Word and your study, reading, and memorization. Those things assist meditation, but they do not replace it.

He said day and night, day and night, day and night.

How would I approach something like the book of John? Very simply. Get it out. Read each verse precisely and deliberately, understanding the content of each verse. You may not know what the verse means, but understand what it says.

For example, "There are three that bear witness: the Spirit, the water, and the blood." I understand what witness means. I know what the Spirit means, and I know what blood means, but I may not know what they all mean together.

Read deliberately and precisely, understanding the content of each verse, even if you do not yet understand what it means. When you finish, go to the next verse.

If you find that you have read eight verses and do not remember what you read, go back to the last one you deliberately paid attention to. Pretty soon you will break yourself from daydreaming.

If you do not understand a word, stop and look it up in the dictionary. The next time you pass through that verse, you will understand the content of the verse, even if not necessarily its meaning.

Before you do anything else, read that book approximately one hundred times like that.

What are you doing? You are allowing the mind of Christ that passed through John concerning love, that whole mind, to begin forming an outline on the inside of you.

Then day-and-night meditation begins to take place. There may be a verse in the third chapter you do not understand and one in the fifth chapter you do not understand. But because the mind of Christ is beginning to form inside you, something will reach out, take the verse in the third chapter and the verse in the fifth chapter, and plug them into the rest of the mind until everything he said is born in you by understanding.

That will take place day and night because you read it one hundred times and let the mind in that book begin to form in you.

The Holy Ghost lives for the day when you will begin to do that.

The Whole Picture Makes the Last Unclear Verse Find Its Place

Let me close with this.

If I were teaching on this gooseneck lamp, this pulpit, this synthetic flower arrangement, and these steps, my goal would be to transport the image of this into you.

Every scripture in the book of John is a thought within itself. But invariably, each one is a stroke of the brush that is always building toward the completion of the entire picture.

Now suppose all of this has been painted except one verse is missing. I have wanted to know what that verse means for a long time. If the only stroke of the brush left is this flower, would it not help your meditation if the rest of it had been painted into place?

You could look up and say, "What appears on the end of a stem on a rosebush? What is that? I do not know what these are. They look like a cross between a carnation and a rose. I wonder what will appear on the end of that little stem."

Then you look at what has appeared on the end of the other stems: a flower.

Do you reckon a flower goes there? Yes, because the rest of the image has formed in you. The subject has formed in you.

In the same way, the one last verse you did not understand is able to rise up because of the information of the entire subject and fit itself in.

You have fed into your spirit the raw material. You have provided the Teacher of all teachers with what He needs to minister to your wisdom and understanding. You have provided the greatest Teacher who ever lived what He needs for day-and-night meditation, not only when you are looking at the Word, but day and night.

Faith comes only one way: by hearing, and hearing by the Word of God. It does not come by your victories or your defeats. It comes by hearing what the Word of God said about your problem, your victory, your life. Just one way.

People say, "If the Word says it, I believe it, and that settles it."

That is wrong. This is not a democracy. God did not ask you for your vote. The Word of God is so whether you believe it or not. Your job is to find it, not change it.

Eighty-five years of ministry. Show some respect. Show some respect.

Usually, after about thirty times through First John, people want to go hit somebody. It shows you how synthetic and plastic you are. You have something in you that is unlovely, something that does not love people. About thirty or forty times through, whatever that is will go to war with that book.

One of you is going to stop.

I hope it is not the book.

Is He not wonderful?